The next day Kaarthikeyan sent a message from Colombo that the ‘human bomb’ was reported to be one ‘Sundari’ from Jaffna and that her parents were staying at Kottivakkam on the way to the famous tourist destination Mahabalipuram. He gave the detailed address. A team led by Verma and Ragothaman swung into action and headed for Kottivakkam. CRPF commandos in armoured vehicles and a small backup team of the Tamil Nadu police rushed to the spot.

On reaching the coastal town 18 km off Madras, the raiding team found Sundari’s parents had four sons and three daughters. The eldest daughter, who ran a garment shop, was in Jaffna at that time. The two younger daughters were present at home. Verma contacted Malligai on their wireless phone and sought verification of the said girl’s presence in Jaffna. In about thirty minutes, the SIT’s contact from Jaffna reported back confirming Sundari’s presence there. Verma and the rest of the raiding team figured that Sundari could not be the ‘human bomb’ as she was alive. On the way back to Malligai, Ragothaman explained to Verma that usually the younger generation of Sri Lankan Tamil expatriates sympathized with the LTTE, but that did not necessarily make them militants. Verma’s mood was still off. None of the raids till then had produced any positive result.

That night, Verma had a telephone chat with his wife, Shobhana, in Delhi. She tried to cheer him up by citing old cases where he had achieved a breakthrough only after crossing many hurdles. She wanted to come to Madras for a couple of days, but Verma did not sound very encouraging. He told her to wait. There was not a minute of free time available for the investigators. Anirudhya, too, kept trying his number, but it seemed to be ‘busy’ all the time. He and Verma had planned to catch up that night. He pulled out his portable typewriter and sat down to write whatever was pending from his usual handwritten notes. He wanted to return to Delhi with a clear picture of the investigation so far.